SHEET 2 OF 6 · INTAKE CHECKLIST

The unpacking list for a tax folder

A tax shoebox always weighs more than it looks. This is the runbook for emptying it: every form that might arrive between January and spring, with a box for *have it* and a box for *still waiting*. Waiting boxes are honest boxes — they tell you exactly who to nudge.

FORM / PAPER	IN FRIENDLY WORDS	HAVE IT	WAITING	N/A
JOBS AND WAGES				
W-2	One from every employer you had, including brief jobs and side gigs with a payroll department.	☐	☐	☐
Final pay stub of the year	The bridge until the real W-2 shows up. Compare the two, then retire the stub.	☐	☐	☐
FREELANCE AND SELF-EMPLOYED				
1099-NEC	Money clients paid you directly for work. One per client who paid enough to report.	☐	☐	☐
1099-MISC	Other payments: rent to you, prizes, awards, that sort of thing.	☐	☐	☐
1099-K	The card-app and marketplace report: payment apps, storefronts, delivery platforms.	☐	☐	☐
BANKS AND INVESTMENTS				
1099-INT	Interest a bank paid you, even modest amounts.	☐	☐	☐
1099-DIV	Dividends and distributions from investments you hold.	☐	☐	☐
1099-B	Stock or fund sales: each sale became a line on here.	☐	☐	☐
Year-end statements	Bank and card December statements. Your year in one place.	☐	☐	☐
HOME, HEALTH, AND FAMILY				
1098 (mortgage)	The mortgage statement lenders mail in January.	☐	☐	☐
Property tax bill or receipt	The annual bill, or the county's printed year-end summary.	☐	☐	☐
1098-T (tuition)	College and coursework statements, for you or someone you support.	☐	☐	☐
Childcare provider statement	Provider name, tax number, amount paid. Ask them for it if none arrived.	☐	☐	☐
Health-insurance letter (1095)	Marketplace or employer coverage paperwork that health plans send out.	☐	☐	☐
Medical & pharmacy summaries		☐	☐	☐

FORM / PAPER	IN FRIENDLY WORDS	HAVE IT	WAITING	N/A
	Statements from insurers and pharmacies; your own tally if you kept one.			
RETIREMENT, GOVERNMENT, AND THE UNUSUAL				
1099-R (retirement)	Distributions from pensions, 401(k)s, IRAs.	☐	☐	☐
SSA-1099 (benefits)	Social Security benefits statement.	☐	☐	☐
1099-G (government)	State refunds, unemployment notices, similar government payments.	☐	☐	☐
K-1 (partnerships)	If an investment or family business sent you one, it tends to arrive fashionably late.	☐	☐	☐

WARM TIP

Keep this sheet on the folder's front page. When a form arrives, tick *have it* and drop it behind this sheet — filing takes ten seconds and removes one open loop from your mind. If a sender is letting you down, tick *waiting* and write the sender's name in the margin. Missing forms almost always mean a quick message to that sender's HR, bank, or platform resolved everything.